

Approximately 3.6 million Australians were ‘food insecure’ (not enough food to feed themselves) in the last 12 months, according to Foodbank, the largest hunger relief organisation in Australia.

Foodbank in fact provides food for 183 000 meals each day, distributed through local community charities.

Yet with all these meals, it’s still not enough. Last year charities across Australia had to turn away 65 000 hungry people each month because there wasn’t enough food to go around.

When I heard this, I thought they were referring to homeless people.

I was wrong.

Almost half (48 per cent) of food-insecure Australians are employed in some way.

And then I stumbled across a figure from Foodbank research that absolutely blew my mind:

One in five schoolkids arrives at school hungry.

That explains why approximately 1750 schools across the country have Breakfast Clubs, to ensure kids are getting their most important meal of the day.

They’re in poor areas. They’re in wealthy areas. They’re in my home town. Chances are there are at least a couple of rumbling tummies in your kids’ classes.

Look, all I’m saying is that food is the perfect way to teach your kids about helping.

Every kid knows what it’s like to be hungry: you can’t concentrate, and you’re irritable until you eat. Well, on a typical day roughly four students in each class will arrive at school hungry or without having eaten breakfast.

And your kids have the chance to do something about it.

Breaking the brat (at any age)